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1 These are the names of the sons of Israel who went to Egypt with Jacob,
each with his family: [2] Reuben, Simeon, Levi, and Judah; [3] Issachar, Zebulun,
and Benjamin; [4] Dan and Naphtali; Gad and Asher. [5] The descendants of Jacob
numbered seventy in all, including Joseph, who was already in Egypt. [6] Now
Joseph and all his brothers and all that generation died, [7] but the Israelites
were fruitful and increased rapidly; they multiplied and became exceedingly
numerous, so that the land was filled with them. [8] Then a new king, who did
not know Joseph, came to power in Egypt. [9] "Look," he said to his people, "the
Israelites have become too numerous and too powerful for us." [10] "Come, let us
deal shrewdly with them, or they will increase even more; and if a war breaks out,
they may join our enemies, fight against us, and leave the country."

[11] So the Egyptians appointed taskmasters over the Israelites to oppress them
with forced labor. As a result, they built Pithom and Rameses as store cities
for Pharaoh. [12] But the more they were oppressed, the more they multiplied and
flourished; so the Egyptians came to dread the Israelites. [13] They worked the
Israelites ruthlessly

[14] and made their lives bitter with hard labor in brick and mortar, and with
all kinds of work in the fields. Every service they imposed was harsh. [15] Then
the king of Egypt said to the Hebrew midwives, whose names were Shiphrah
and Puah, [16] "When you help the Hebrew women give birth, observe them on
the birthstools. If the child is a son, kill him; but if it is a daughter, let her live."
[17] The midwives, however, feared God and did not do as the king of Egypt had
instructed; they let the boys live. [18] So the king of Egypt summoned the midwives
and asked them, "Why have you done this? Why have you let the boys live?"
[19] The midwives answered Pharaoh, "The Hebrew women are not like the
Egyptian women, for they are vigorous and give birth before a midwife arrives."
[20] So God was good to the midwives, and the people multiplied and became even
more numerous. [21] And because the midwives feared God, He gave them families
of their own. [22] Then Pharaoh commanded all his people: "Every son born to
the Hebrews you must throw into the Nile, but every daughter you may allow
to live."

2 Now a man of the house of Levi married a daughter of Levi, [2] and she
conceived and gave birth to a son. When she saw that he was a beautiful child,
she hid him for three months. [3] But when she could no longer hide him, she got
him a papyrus basket and coated it with tar and pitch. Then she placed the child
in the basket and set it among the reeds along the bank of the Nile. [4] And his
sister stood at a distance to see what would happen to him. [5] Soon the daughter
of Pharaoh went down to bathe in the Nile, and her attendants were walking
along the riverbank. And when she saw the basket among the reeds, she sent her
maidservant to retrieve it. [6] When she opened it, she saw the child, and behold,
the little boy was crying. So she had compassion on him and said, "This is one of
the Hebrew children." [7] Then his sister said to Pharaoh's daughter, "Shall I go
and call one of the Hebrew women to nurse the child for you?"

[8] "Go ahead," Pharaoh's daughter told her. And the girl went and called the
boy's mother. [9] Pharaoh's daughter said to her, "Take this child and nurse him
for me, and I will pay your wages." So the woman took the boy and nursed him.
[10] When the child had grown older, she brought him to Pharaoh's daughter, and
he became her son. She named him Moses and explained, "I drew him out of
the water." [11] One day, after Moses had grown up, he went out to his own people
and observed their hard labor. He saw an Egyptian beating a Hebrew, one of
his own people.

[12] After looking this way and that and seeing no one, he struck down the
Egyptian and hid his body in the sand. [13] The next day Moses went out and saw
two Hebrews fighting. He asked the one in the wrong, "Why are you attacking
your companion?" [14] But the man replied, "Who made you ruler and judge over
us? Are you planning to kill me as you killed the Egyptian?" Then Moses was
afraid and thought, "This thing I have done has surely become known." [15] When
Pharaoh heard about this matter, he sought to kill Moses. But Moses fled from
Pharaoh and settled in the land of Midian, where he sat down beside a well.

[16] Now the priest of Midian had seven daughters, and they came to draw water
and fill the troughs to water their father's flock. [17] And when some shepherds
came along and drove them away, Moses rose up to help them and watered
their flock. [18] When the daughters returned to their father Reuel, he asked them,
"Why have you returned so early today?" [19] "An Egyptian rescued us from the
shepherds," they replied. "He even drew water for us and watered the flock."
[20] "So where is he?" their father asked. "Why did you leave the man behind?
Invite him to have something to eat." [21] Moses agreed to stay with the man, and
he gave his daughter Zipporah to Moses in marriage. [22] And she gave birth to
a son, and Moses named him Gershom, saying, "I have become a foreigner in a
foreign land." [23] After a long time, the king of Egypt died. The Israelites groaned
and cried out under their burden of slavery, and their cry for deliverance from
bondage ascended to God. [24] So God heard their groaning, and He remembered
His covenant with Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob. [25] God saw the Israelites and
took notice.

3 Meanwhile, Moses was shepherding the flock of his father-in-law Jethro, the
priest of Midian. He led the flock to the far side of the wilderness and came to
Horeb, the mountain of God. [2] There the angel of the LORD appeared to him
in a blazing fire from within a bush. Moses saw the bush ablaze with fire, but it
was not consumed. [3] So Moses thought, "I must go over and see this marvelous
sight. Why is the bush not burning up?" [4] When the LORD saw that he had
gone over to look, God called out to him from within the bush, "Moses, Moses!"
"Here I am," he answered. [5] "Do not come any closer," God said. "Take off your
sandals, for the place where you are standing is holy ground." [6] Then He said, "I
am the God of your father, the God of Abraham, the God of Isaac, and the God
of Jacob." At this, Moses hid his face, for he was afraid to look at God.

[7] The LORD said, "I have indeed seen the affliction of My people in Egypt.
I have heard them crying out because of their oppressors, and I am aware of
their sufferings." [8] I have come down to rescue them from the hand of the
Egyptians and to bring them up out of that land to a good and spacious land,
a land flowing with milk and honey—the home of the Canaanites, Hittites,
Amorites, Perizzites, Hivites, and Jebusites. [9] And now the cry of the Israelites
has reached Me, and I have seen how severely the Egyptians are oppressing them.
[10] "Therefore, go! I am sending you to Pharaoh to bring My people the Israelites
out of Egypt." [11] But Moses asked God, "Who am I, that I should go to Pharaoh
and bring the Israelites out of Egypt?" [12] "I will surely be with you," God said,
"and this will be the sign to you that I have sent you: When you have brought
the people out of Egypt, all of you will worship God on this mountain." [13] Then
Moses asked God, "Suppose I go to the Israelites and say to them, 'The God of
your fathers has sent me to you,' and they ask me, 'What is His name?' What
should I tell them?"

[14] God said to Moses, "I AM WHO I AM. This is what you are to say to
the Israelites: 'I AM has sent me to you.'" [15] God also told Moses, "Say to the
Israelites, 'The LORD, the God of your fathers—the God of Abraham, the God
of Isaac, and the God of Jacob—has sent me to you.' This is My name forever,
and this is how I am to be remembered in every generation."

[16] Go, assemble the elders of Israel and say to them, 'The LORD, the God of your
fathers—the God of Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob—has appeared to me and said: I
have surely attended to you and have seen what has been done to you in Egypt.'
[17] And I have promised to bring you up out of your affliction in Egypt, into the
land of the Canaanites, Hittites, Amorites, Perizzites, Hivites, and Jebusites—a
land flowing with milk and honey.' [18] The elders of Israel will listen to what you
say, and you must go with them to the king of Egypt and tell him, 'The LORD,
the God of the Hebrews, has met with us. Now please let us take a three-day
journey into the wilderness, so that we may sacrifice to the LORD our God.'
[19] But I know that the king of Egypt will not allow you to go unless a mighty hand
compels him. [20] So I will stretch out My hand and strike the Egyptians with all the
wonders I will perform among them. And after that, he will release you. [21] And I
will grant this people such favor in the sight of the Egyptians that when you leave,
you will not go away empty-handed. [22] "Every woman shall ask her neighbor and
any woman staying in her house for silver and gold jewelry and clothing, and you
will put them on your sons and daughters. So you will plunder the Egyptians."

4 Then Moses answered, "What if they do not believe me or listen to my voice?
For they may say, 'The LORD has not appeared to you.'" [2] And the LORD
asked him, "What is that in your hand?" "A staff," he replied. [3] "Throw it on
the ground," said the LORD. So Moses threw it on the ground, and it became
a snake, and he ran from it. [4] "Stretch out your hand and grab it by the tail,"
the LORD said to Moses, who reached out his hand and caught the snake, and
it turned back into a staff in his hand. [5] "This is so that they may believe that
the LORD, the God of their fathers—the God of Abraham, the God of Isaac,
and the God of Jacob—has appeared to you." [6] Furthermore, the LORD said to
Moses, "Put your hand inside your cloak." So he put his hand inside his cloak,
and when he took it out, his hand was leprous, white as snow. [7] "Put your hand
back inside your cloak," said the LORD. So Moses put his hand back inside his
cloak, and when he took it out, it was restored, like the rest of his skin. [8] And
the LORD said, "If they refuse to believe you or heed the witness of the first
sign, they may believe that of the second." [9] "But if they do not believe even
these two signs or listen to your voice, take some water from the Nile and pour
it on the dry ground. Then the water you take from the Nile will become blood
on the ground."

[10] "Please, Lord," Moses replied, "I have never been eloquent, neither in the
past nor since You have spoken to Your servant, for I am slow of speech
and tongue." [11] And the LORD said to him, "Who gave man his mouth? Or who
makes the mute or the deaf, the sighted or the blind? Is it not I, the LORD?"
[12] "Now go! I will help you as you speak, and I will teach you what to say." [13] But
Moses replied, "Please, Lord, send someone else."

[14] Then the anger of the LORD burned against Moses, and He said, "Is not
Aaron the Levite your brother? I know that he can speak well, and he is now on
his way to meet you. When he sees you, he will be glad in his heart." [15] You are to
speak to him and put the words in his mouth. I will help both of you to speak,
and I will teach you what to do. [16] He will speak to the people for you. He will

be your spokesman, and it will be as if you were God to him. [17] "But take this staff in your hand so you can perform signs with it." [18] Then Moses went back to his father-in-law Jethro and said to him, "Please let me return to my brothers in Egypt to see if they are still alive." "Go in peace," Jethro replied. [19] Now the LORD had said to Moses in Midian, "Go back to Egypt, for all the men who sought to kill you are dead."

[20] So Moses took his wife and sons, put them on a donkey, and headed back to Egypt. And he took the staff of God in his hand. [21] The LORD instructed Moses, "When you go back to Egypt, see that you perform before Pharaoh all the wonders that I have put within your power. But I will harden his heart so that he will not let the people go." [22] Then tell Pharaoh that this is what the LORD says: 'Israel is My firstborn son,' [23] "and I told you to let My son go so that he may worship Me. But since you have refused to let him go, behold, I will kill your firstborn son!'" [24] Now at a lodging place along the way, the LORD met Moses and was about to kill him. [25] But Zipporah took a flint knife, cut off her son's foreskin, and touched it to Moses' feet. "Surely you are a bridegroom of blood to me," she said. [26] So the LORD let him alone. (When she said, "bridegroom of blood," she was referring to the circumcision.) [27] Meanwhile, the LORD had said to Aaron, "Go and meet Moses in the wilderness." So he went and met Moses at the mountain of God and kissed him. [28] And Moses told Aaron everything the LORD had sent him to say, and all the signs He had commanded him to perform. [29] Then Moses and Aaron went and assembled all the elders of the Israelites, [30] and Aaron relayed everything the LORD had said to Moses. And Moses performed the signs before the people, [31] and they believed. And when they heard that the LORD had attended to the Israelites and had seen their affliction, they bowed down and worshiped.

5 After that, Moses and Aaron went to Pharaoh and said, "This is what the LORD, the God of Israel, says: 'Let My people go, so that they may hold a feast to Me in the wilderness.'" [2] But Pharaoh replied, "Who is the LORD that I should obey His voice and let Israel go? I do not know the LORD, and I will not let Israel go." [3] "The God of the Hebrews has met with us," they answered. "Please let us go on a three-day journey into the wilderness to sacrifice to the LORD our God, or He may strike us with plagues or with the sword." [4] But the king of Egypt said to them, "Moses and Aaron, why do you draw the people away from their work? Get back to your labor!" [5] Pharaoh also said, "Look, the people of the land are now numerous, and you would be stopping them from their labor." [6] That same day Pharaoh commanded the taskmasters of the people and their foremen: [7] "You shall no longer supply the people with straw for making bricks. They must go and gather their own straw." [8] But require of them the same quota of bricks as before; do not reduce it. For they are lazy; that is why they are crying out, 'Let us go and sacrifice to our God.' [9] "Make the work harder on the men so they will be occupied and pay no attention to these lies." [10] So the taskmasters and foremen of the people went out and said to them, "This is what Pharaoh says: 'I am no longer giving you straw.'" [11] "Go and get your own straw wherever you can find it; but your workload will in no way be reduced.'"

[12] So the people scattered all over the land of Egypt to gather stubble for straw. [13] The taskmasters kept pressing them, saying, "Fulfill your quota each day, just as you did when straw was provided." [14] Then the Israelite foremen, whom Pharaoh's taskmasters had set over the people, were beaten and asked, "Why have you not fulfilled your quota of bricks yesterday or today, as you did before?"

[15] So the Israelite foremen went and appealed to Pharaoh: "Why are you treating your servants this way?" [16] "No straw has been given to your servants, yet we are told, 'Make bricks!' Look, your servants are being beaten, but the fault is with your own people." [17] "You are slackers!" Pharaoh replied. "Slackers! That is why you keep saying, 'Let us go and sacrifice to the LORD.'" [18] "Now get to work. You will be given no straw, yet you must deliver the full quota of bricks." [19] The Israelite foremen realized they were in trouble when they were told, "You must not reduce your daily quota of bricks." [20] When they left Pharaoh, they confronted Moses and Aaron, who stood waiting to meet them. [21] "May the LORD look upon you and judge you," the foremen said, "for you have made us a stench before Pharaoh and his officials; you have placed in their hand a sword to kill us!" [22] So Moses returned to the LORD and asked, "Lord, why have You brought trouble upon this people? Is this why You sent me?" [23] "Ever since I went to Pharaoh to speak in Your name, he has brought trouble on this people, and You have not delivered Your people in any way."

6 But the LORD said to Moses, "Now you will see what I will do to Pharaoh, for because of My mighty hand he will let the people go; because of My strong hand he will drive them out of his land." [2] God also told Moses, "I am the LORD." [3] I appeared to Abraham, to Isaac, and to Jacob as God Almighty, but by My name the LORD I did not make Myself known to them. [4] I also established My covenant with them to give them the land of Canaan, the land where they lived as foreigners. [5] Furthermore, I have heard the groaning of the Israelites, whom the Egyptians are enslaving, and I have remembered My covenant. [6] Therefore tell the Israelites: 'I am the LORD, and I will bring you out from under the yoke of the Egyptians and deliver you from their bondage. I will redeem you with an outstretched arm and with mighty acts of judgment.' [7] I will take you as My own people, and I will be your God. Then you will know that I am the LORD your God, who brought you out from under the yoke of the Egyptians. [8] "And I will bring you into the land that I swore to give to Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob. I will give it to you as a possession. I am the LORD!'" [9] Moses relayed this message to the Israelites, but on account of their broken spirit and cruel bondage, they did not listen to him.

[10] So the LORD said to Moses, [11] "Go and tell Pharaoh king of Egypt to let the Israelites go out of his land." [12] But in the LORD's presence Moses replied, "If the Israelites will not listen to me, then why would Pharaoh listen to me, since I am unskilled in speech?"

[13] Then the LORD spoke to Moses and Aaron and gave them a charge concerning both the Israelites and Pharaoh king of Egypt, to bring the Israelites out of the land of Egypt.

[14] These were the heads of their fathers' houses: The sons of Reuben, the firstborn of Israel, were Hanoch and Pallu, Hezron and Carmi. These were the clans of Reuben.

[15] The sons of Simeon were Jemuel, Jamin, Ohad, Jachin, Zohar, and Shaul, the son of a Canaanite woman. These were the clans of Simeon.

[16] These were the names of the sons of Levi according to their records: Gershon, Kohath, and Merari. Levi lived 137 years.

[17] The sons of Gershon were Libni and Shimei, by their clans.

[18] The sons of Kohath were Amram, Izhar, Hebron, and Uzziel. Kohath lived 133 years.

[19] The sons of Merari were Mahli and Mushi. These were the clans of the Levites according to their records.

[20] And Amram married his father's sister Jochebed, and she bore him Aaron and Moses. Amram lived 137 years.

[21] The sons of Izhar were Korah, Nepheg, and Zichri.

[22] The sons of Uzziel were Mishael, Elzaphan, and Sithri.

[23] And Aaron married Elisheba, the daughter of Amminadab and sister of Nahshon, and she bore him Nadab and Abihu, Eleazar and Ithamar.

[24] The sons of Korah were Assir, Elkanah, and Abiasaph. These were the clans of the Korahites.

[25] Aaron's son Eleazar married one of the daughters of Putiel, and she bore him Phinehas. These were the heads of the Levite families by their clans. [26] It was this Aaron and Moses to whom the LORD said, "Bring the Israelites out of the land of Egypt by their divisions." [27] Moses and Aaron were the ones who spoke to Pharaoh king of Egypt in order to bring the Israelites out of Egypt. [28] Now on the day that the LORD spoke to Moses in Egypt, [29] He said to him, "I am the LORD; tell Pharaoh king of Egypt everything I say to you." [30] But in the LORD's presence Moses replied, "Since I am unskilled in speech, why would Pharaoh listen to me?"

7 The LORD answered Moses, "See, I have made you like God to Pharaoh, and your brother Aaron will be your prophet." [2] You are to speak all that I command you, and your brother Aaron is to tell Pharaoh to let the Israelites go out of his land. [3] But I will harden Pharaoh's heart, and though I will multiply My signs and wonders in the land of Egypt, [4] Pharaoh will not listen to you. Then I will lay My hand on Egypt, and by mighty acts of judgment I will bring the divisions of My people the Israelites out of the land of Egypt. [5] "And the Egyptians will know that I am the LORD, when I stretch out My hand against Egypt and bring the Israelites out from among them." [6] So Moses and Aaron did just as the LORD had commanded them. [7] Moses was eighty years old and Aaron was eighty-three when they spoke to Pharaoh.

[8] The LORD said to Moses and Aaron, [9] "When Pharaoh tells you, 'Perform a miracle,' you are to say to Aaron, 'Take your staff and throw it down before Pharaoh,' and it will become a serpent." [10] So Moses and Aaron went to Pharaoh and did just as the LORD had commanded. Aaron threw his staff down before Pharaoh and his officials, and it became a serpent.

[11] But Pharaoh called the wise men and sorcerers and magicians of Egypt, and they also did the same things by their magic arts. [12] Each one threw down his staff, and it became a serpent. But Aaron's staff swallowed up the other staffs. [13] Still, Pharaoh's heart was hardened, and he would not listen to them, just as the LORD had said. [14] Then the LORD said to Moses, "Pharaoh's heart is unyielding; he refuses to let the people go." [15] Go to Pharaoh in the morning as you see him walking out to the water. Wait on the bank of the Nile to meet him, and take in your hand the staff that was changed into a snake.

[16] Then say to him, 'The LORD, the God of the Hebrews, has sent me to tell you: Let My people go, so that they may worship Me in the wilderness. But you have not listened until now.' [17] This is what the LORD says: By this you will know that I am the LORD. Behold, with the staff in my hand I will strike the water of the Nile, and it will turn to blood. [18] "The fish in the Nile will die, the river will stink, and the Egyptians will be unable to drink its water.'" [19] And the LORD said to Moses, "Tell Aaron, 'Take your staff and stretch out your hand over the waters of Egypt—over their rivers and canals and ponds and reservoirs—that they may become blood.' There will be blood throughout the land of Egypt, even in the vessels of wood and stone." [20] Moses and Aaron did just as the LORD had commanded; in the presence of Pharaoh and his officials, Aaron raised the staff and struck the water of the Nile, and all the water was turned to blood. [21] The fish in the Nile died, and the river smelled so bad that the Egyptians could not drink its water. And there was blood throughout the land of Egypt. [22] But the magicians of Egypt did the same things by their magic arts. So Pharaoh's heart was hardened, and he would not listen to Moses and Aaron, just as the LORD had said. [23] Instead, Pharaoh turned around, went into his palace, and did not

take any of this to heart. [24] So all the Egyptians dug around the Nile for water to drink, because they could not drink the water from the river. [25] And seven full days passed after the LORD had struck the Nile.

8 Then the LORD said to Moses, "Go to Pharaoh and tell him that this is what the LORD says: 'Let My people go, so that they may worship Me.'" [2] But if you refuse to let them go, I will plague your whole country with frogs. [3] The Nile will teem with frogs, and they will come into your palace and up to your bedroom and onto your bed, into the houses of your officials and your people, and into your ovens and kneading bowls. [4] "The frogs will come up on you and your people and all your officials.'" [5] And the LORD said to Moses, "Tell Aaron, 'Stretch out your hand with your staff over the rivers and canals and ponds, and cause the frogs to come up onto the land of Egypt.'" [6] So Aaron stretched out his hand over the waters of Egypt, and the frogs came up and covered the land of Egypt. [7] But the magicians did the same thing by their magic arts, and they also brought frogs up onto the land of Egypt. [8] Pharaoh summoned Moses and Aaron and said, "Pray to the LORD to take the frogs away from me and my people. Then I will let your people go, that they may sacrifice to the LORD." [9] Moses said to Pharaoh, "You may have the honor over me. When shall I pray for you and your officials and your people that the frogs (except for those in the Nile) may be taken away from you and your houses?"

[10] "Tomorrow," Pharaoh answered. "May it be as you say," Moses replied, "so that you may know that there is no one like the LORD our God." [11] "The frogs will depart from you and your houses and your officials and your people; they will remain only in the Nile." [12] After Moses and Aaron had left Pharaoh, Moses cried out to the LORD for help with the frogs that He had brought against Pharaoh. [13] And the LORD did as Moses requested, and the frogs in the houses, the courtyards, and the fields died. [14] They were piled into countless heaps, and there was a terrible stench in the land. [15] When Pharaoh saw that there was relief, however, he hardened his heart and would not listen to Moses and Aaron, just as the LORD had said.

[16] Then the LORD said to Moses, "Tell Aaron, 'Stretch out your staff and strike the dust of the earth, that it may turn into swarms of gnats throughout the land of Egypt.'" [17] This they did, and when Aaron stretched out his hand with his staff and struck the dust of the earth, gnats came upon man and beast. All the dust of the earth turned into gnats throughout the land of Egypt. [18] The magicians tried to produce gnats using their magic arts, but they could not. And the gnats remained on man and beast. [19] "This is the finger of God," the magicians said to Pharaoh. But Pharaoh's heart was hardened, and he would not listen to them, just as the LORD had said. [20] Then the LORD said to Moses, "Get up early in the morning, and when Pharaoh goes out to the water, stand before him and tell him that this is what the LORD says: 'Let My people go, so that they may worship Me.'"

[21] But if you will not let My people go, I will send swarms of flies upon you and your officials and your people and your houses. The houses of the Egyptians and even the ground where they stand will be full of flies. [22] But on that day I will give special treatment to the land of Goshen, where My people live; no swarms of flies will be found there. In this way you will know that I, the LORD, am in the land. [23] "I will make a distinction between My people and your people. This sign will take place tomorrow.'" [24] And the LORD did so. Thick swarms of flies poured into Pharaoh's palace and into the houses of his officials. Throughout Egypt the land was ruined by swarms of flies. [25] Then Pharaoh summoned Moses and Aaron and said, "Go, sacrifice to your God within this land." [26] But Moses replied, "It would not be right to do that, because the sacrifices we offer to the LORD our God would be detestable to the Egyptians. If we offer sacrifices that are detestable before the Egyptians, will they not stone us?" [27] "We must make a three-day journey into the wilderness and sacrifice to the LORD our God as He commands us." [28] Pharaoh answered, "I will let you go and sacrifice to the LORD your God in the wilderness, but you must not go very far. Now pray for me." [29] "As soon as I leave you," Moses said, "I will pray to the LORD, so that tomorrow the swarms of flies will depart from Pharaoh and his officials and his people. But Pharaoh must not act deceitfully again by refusing to let the people go and sacrifice to the LORD." [30] Then Moses left Pharaoh and prayed to the LORD, [31] and the LORD did as Moses requested. He removed the swarms of flies from Pharaoh and his officials and his people; not one fly remained. [32] But Pharaoh hardened his heart this time as well, and he would not let the people go.

9 Then the LORD said to Moses, "Go to Pharaoh and tell him that this is what the LORD, the God of the Hebrews, says: 'Let My people go, so that they may worship Me.'" [2] But if you continue to restrain them and refuse to let them go, [3] then the hand of the LORD will bring a severe plague on your livestock in the field—on your horses, donkeys, camels, herds, and flocks. [4] "But the LORD will make a distinction between the livestock of Israel and the livestock of Egypt, so that no animal belonging to the Israelites will die.'" [5] The LORD set a time, saying, "Tomorrow the LORD will do this in the land." [6] And the next day the LORD did just that. All the livestock of the Egyptians died, but not one animal belonging to the Israelites died. [7] Pharaoh sent officials and found that none of the livestock of the Israelites had died. But Pharaoh's heart was hardened, and he would not let the people go. [8] Then the LORD said to Moses and Aaron, "Take handfuls of soot from the furnace; in the sight of Pharaoh, Moses is to toss it into the air." [9] "It will become fine dust over all the land of Egypt, and festering boils will break out on man and beast throughout the land." [10] So they took soot from the furnace and stood before Pharaoh. Moses tossed it into the air, and festering boils broke out on man and beast.

[11] The magicians could not stand before Moses, because the boils had broken out on them and on all the Egyptians. [12] But the LORD hardened Pharaoh's heart, and he would not listen to them, just as the LORD had said to Moses. [13] Then the LORD said to Moses, "Get up early in the morning, stand before Pharaoh, and tell him that this is what the LORD, the God of the Hebrews, says: 'Let My people go, so that they may worship Me.'" [14] Otherwise, I will send all My plagues against you and your officials and your people, so you may know that there is no one like Me in all the earth. [15] For by this time I could have stretched out My hand and struck you and your people with a plague to wipe you off the earth. [16] But I have raised you up for this very purpose, that I might display My power to you, and that My name might be proclaimed in all the earth. [17] Still, you lord it over My people and do not allow them to go.

[18] Behold, at this time tomorrow I will rain down the worst hail that has ever fallen on Egypt, from the day it was founded until now. [19] "So give orders now to shelter your livestock and everything you have in the field. Every man or beast that remains in the field and is not brought inside will die when the hail comes down upon them.'" [20] Those among Pharaoh's officials who feared the word of the LORD hurried to bring their servants and livestock to shelter, [21] but those who disregarded the word of the LORD left their servants and livestock in the field. [22] Then the LORD said to Moses, "Stretch out your hand toward heaven, so that hail may fall on all the land of Egypt—on man and beast and every plant of the field throughout the land of Egypt."

[23] So Moses stretched out his staff toward heaven, and the LORD sent thunder and hail, and lightning struck the earth. So the LORD rained down hail upon the land of Egypt. [24] The hail fell and the lightning continued flashing through it. The hail was so severe that nothing like it had ever been seen in all the land of Egypt from the time it became a nation. [25] Throughout the land of Egypt, the hail struck down everything in the field, both man and beast; it beat down every plant of the field and stripped every tree. [26] The only place where it did not hail was in the land of Goshen, where the Israelites lived. [27] Then Pharaoh summoned Moses and Aaron. "This time I have sinned," he said. "The LORD is righteous, and I and my people are wicked." [28] "Pray to the LORD, for there has been enough of God's thunder and hail. I will let you go; you do not need to stay any longer." [29] Moses said to him, "When I have left the city, I will spread out my hands to the LORD. The thunder will cease, and there will be no more hail, so that you may know that the earth is the LORD's." [30] "But as for you and your officials, I know that you still do not fear the LORD our God." [31] (Now the flax and barley were destroyed, since the barley was ripe and the flax was in bloom; [32] but the wheat and spelt were not destroyed, because they are late crops.) [33] Then Moses departed from Pharaoh, went out of the city, and spread out his hands to the LORD. The thunder and hail ceased, and the rain no longer poured down on the land. [34] When Pharaoh saw that the rain and hail and thunder had ceased, he sinned again and hardened his heart—he and his officials. [35] So Pharaoh's heart was hardened, and he would not let the Israelites go, just as the LORD had said through Moses.

10 Then the LORD said to Moses, "Go to Pharaoh, for I have hardened his heart and the hearts of his officials, that I may perform these miraculous signs of Mine among them," [2] "and that you may tell your children and grandchildren how severely I dealt with the Egyptians when I performed miraculous signs among them, so that all of you may know that I am the LORD." [3] So Moses and Aaron went to Pharaoh and told him, "This is what the LORD, the God of the Hebrews, says: 'How long will you refuse to humble yourself before Me? Let My people go, so that they may worship Me.'" [4] But if you refuse to let My people go, I will bring locusts into your territory tomorrow. [5] They will cover the face of the land so that no one can see it. They will devour whatever is left after the hail and eat every tree that grows in your fields. [6] "They will fill your houses and the houses of all your officials and every Egyptian—something neither your fathers nor your grandfathers have seen since the day they came into this land.'" Then Moses turned and left Pharaoh's presence. [7] Pharaoh's officials asked him, "How long will this man be a snare to us? Let the people go, so that they may worship the LORD their God. Do you not yet realize that Egypt is in ruins?" [8] So Moses and Aaron were brought back to Pharaoh. "Go, worship the LORD your God," he said. "But who exactly will be going?"

[9] "We will go with our young and old," Moses replied. "We will go with our sons and daughters, and with our flocks and herds, for we must hold a feast to the LORD." [10] Then Pharaoh told them, "May the LORD be with you if I ever let you go with your little ones. Clearly you are bent on evil." [11] "No, only the men may go and worship the LORD, since that is what you have been requesting." And Moses and Aaron were driven from Pharaoh's presence.

[12] Then the LORD said to Moses, "Stretch out your hand over the land of Egypt, so that the locusts may swarm over it and devour every plant in the land—everything that the hail has left behind." [13] So Moses stretched out his staff over the land of Egypt, and throughout that day and night the LORD sent an east wind across the land. By morning the east wind had brought the locusts. [14] The locusts swarmed across the land and settled over the entire territory of Egypt. Never before had there been so many locusts, and never again will there be.

15 They covered the face of all the land until it was black, and they consumed all
the plants on the ground and all the fruit on the trees that the hail had left behind.
Nothing green was left on any tree or plant in all the land of Egypt. 16 Pharaoh
quickly summoned Moses and Aaron and said, "I have sinned against the LORD
your God and against you." 17 "Now please forgive my sin once more and appeal
to the LORD your God, that He may remove this death from me." 18 So Moses
left Pharaoh's presence and appealed to the LORD.

19 And the LORD changed the wind to a very strong west wind that carried
off the locusts and blew them into the Red Sea. Not a single locust remained
anywhere in Egypt. 20 But the LORD hardened Pharaoh's heart, and he would
not let the Israelites go. 21 Then the LORD said to Moses, "Stretch out your
hand toward heaven, so that darkness may spread over the land of Egypt—a
palpable darkness." 22 So Moses stretched out his hand toward heaven, and total
darkness covered all the land of Egypt for three days. 23 No one could see anyone
else, and for three days no one left his place. Yet all the Israelites had light in
their dwellings. 24 Then Pharaoh summoned Moses and said, "Go, worship the
LORD. Even your little ones may go with you; only your flocks and herds must
stay behind." 25 But Moses replied, "You must also provide us with sacrifices and
burnt offerings to present to the LORD our God." 26 "Even our livestock must
go with us; not a hoof will be left behind, for we will need some of them to
worship the LORD our God, and we will not know how we are to worship the
LORD until we arrive." 27 But the LORD hardened Pharaoh's heart, and he was
unwilling to let them go. 28 "Depart from me!" Pharaoh said to Moses. "Make
sure you never see my face again, for on the day you see my face, you will die."
29 "As you say," Moses replied, "I will never see your face again."

11 Then the LORD said to Moses, "I will bring upon Pharaoh and Egypt one
more plague. After that, he will allow you to leave this place. And when he lets
you go, he will drive you out completely." 2 "Now announce to the people that
men and women alike should ask their neighbors for articles of silver and gold."
3 And the LORD gave the people favor in the sight of the Egyptians. Moreover,
Moses himself was highly regarded in Egypt by Pharaoh's officials and by
the people. 4 So Moses declared, "This is what the LORD says: 'About midnight
I will go throughout Egypt,'" 5 and every firstborn son in the land of Egypt will
die, from the firstborn of Pharaoh who sits on his throne, to the firstborn of the
servant girl behind the hand mill, as well as the firstborn of all the cattle. 6 Then
a great cry will go out over all the land of Egypt. Such an outcry has never been
heard before and will never be heard again. 7 But among all the Israelites, not even
a dog will snarl at man or beast.' Then you will know that the LORD makes a
distinction between Egypt and Israel. 8 "And all these officials of yours will come
and bow before me, saying, 'Go, you and all the people who follow you!' After
that, I will depart." And hot with anger, Moses left Pharaoh's presence. 9 The
LORD said to Moses, "Pharaoh will not listen to you, so that My wonders may
be multiplied in the land of Egypt." 10 Moses and Aaron did all these wonders
before Pharaoh, but the LORD hardened Pharaoh's heart so that he would not
let the Israelites go out of his land.

12 Now the LORD said to Moses and Aaron in the land of Egypt, 2 "This
month is the beginning of months for you; it shall be the first month of
your year." 3 Tell the whole congregation of Israel that on the tenth day of
this month each man must select a lamb for his family, one per household. 4 If
the household is too small for a whole lamb, they are to share with the nearest
neighbor based on the number of people, and apportion the lamb accordingly.
5 Your lamb must be an unblemished year-old male, and you may take it from
the sheep or the goats. 6 You must keep it until the fourteenth day of the month,
when the whole assembly of the congregation of Israel will slaughter the animals
at twilight. 7 They are to take some of the blood and put it on the sides and tops of
the doorframes of the houses where they eat the lambs. 8 They are to eat the meat
that night, roasted over the fire, along with unleavened bread and bitter herbs.
9 Do not eat any of the meat raw or cooked in boiling water, but only roasted over
the fire—its head and legs and inner parts. 10 Do not leave any of it until morning;
before the morning you must burn up any part that is left over. 11 This is how you
are to eat it: You must be fully dressed for travel, with your sandals on your feet
and your staff in your hand. You are to eat in haste; it is the LORD's Passover.
12 On that night I will pass through the land of Egypt and strike down every
firstborn male, both man and beast, and I will execute judgment against all the
gods of Egypt. I am the LORD. 13 The blood on the houses where you are staying
will distinguish them; when I see the blood, I will pass over you. No plague
will fall on you to destroy you when I strike the land of Egypt. 14 And this day
will be a memorial for you, and you are to celebrate it as a feast to the LORD,
as a permanent statute for the generations to come. 15 For seven days you must
eat unleavened bread. On the first day you are to remove the leaven from your
houses. Whoever eats anything leavened from the first day through the seventh
must be cut off from Israel. 16 On the first day you are to hold a sacred assembly,
and another on the seventh day. You must not do any work on those days, except
to prepare the meals—that is all you may do.

17 So you are to keep the Feast of Unleavened Bread, for on this very day I
brought your divisions out of the land of Egypt. You must keep this day as a
permanent statute for the generations to come. 18 In the first month you are to
eat unleavened bread, from the evening of the fourteenth day until the evening
of the twenty-first day. 19 For seven days there must be no leaven found in your
houses. If anyone eats something leavened, that person, whether a foreigner or
native of the land, must be cut off from the congregation of Israel. 20 "You are
not to eat anything leavened; eat unleavened bread in all your homes." 21 Then
Moses summoned all the elders of Israel and told them, "Go at once and select
for yourselves a lamb for each family, and slaughter the Passover lamb."

22 Take a cluster of hyssop, dip it into the blood in the basin, and brush the blood
on the top and sides of the doorframe. None of you shall go out the door of
his house until morning. 23 When the LORD passes through to strike down the
Egyptians, He will see the blood on the top and sides of the doorframe and will
pass over that doorway; so He will not allow the destroyer to enter your houses
and strike you down. 24 And you are to keep this command as a permanent statute
for you and your descendants. 25 When you enter the land that the LORD will
give you as He promised, you are to keep this service. 26 When your children ask
you, 'What does this service mean to you?' 27 "you are to reply, 'It is the Passover
sacrifice to the LORD, who passed over the houses of the Israelites in Egypt when
He struck down the Egyptians and spared our homes.'" Then the people bowed
down and worshiped. 28 And the Israelites went and did just what the LORD
had commanded Moses and Aaron. 29 Now at midnight the LORD struck down
every firstborn male in the land of Egypt, from the firstborn of Pharaoh, who sat
on his throne, to the firstborn of the prisoner in the dungeon, as well as all the
firstborn among the livestock. 30 During the night Pharaoh got up—he and all
his officials and all the Egyptians—and there was loud wailing in Egypt; for there
was no house without someone dead. 31 Then Pharaoh summoned Moses and
Aaron by night and said, "Get up, leave my people, both you and the Israelites!
Go, worship the LORD as you have requested." 32 "Take your flocks and herds
as well, just as you have said, and depart! And bless me also." 33 And in order
to send them out of the land quickly, the Egyptians urged the people on. "For
otherwise," they said, "we are all going to die!"

34 So the people took their dough before it was leavened, carrying it on their
shoulders in kneading bowls wrapped in clothing. 35 Furthermore, the Israelites
acted on Moses' word and asked the Egyptians for articles of silver and gold,
and for clothing. 36 And the LORD gave the people such favor in the sight
of the Egyptians that they granted their request. In this way they plundered
the Egyptians. 37 The Israelites journeyed from Rameses to Succoth with about
600,000 men on foot, besides women and children. 38 And a mixed multitude
also went up with them, along with great droves of livestock, both flocks
and herds. 39 Since their dough had no leaven, the people baked what they
had brought out of Egypt into unleavened loaves. For when they had been
driven out of Egypt, they could not delay and had not prepared any provisions
for themselves. 40 Now the duration of the Israelites' stay in Egypt was 430 years.
41 At the end of the 430 years, to the very day, all the LORD's divisions went
out of the land of Egypt. 42 Because the LORD kept a vigil that night to bring
them out of the land of Egypt, this same night is to be a vigil to the LORD, to
be observed by all the Israelites for the generations to come. 43 And the LORD
said to Moses and Aaron, "This is the statute of the Passover: No foreigner is to
eat of it." 44 But any slave who has been purchased may eat of it, after you have
circumcised him. 45 A temporary resident or hired hand shall not eat the Passover.
46 It must be eaten inside one house. You are not to take any of the meat outside
the house, and you may not break any of the bones. 47 The whole congregation
of Israel must celebrate it. 48 If a foreigner resides with you and wants to celebrate
the LORD's Passover, all the males in the household must be circumcised; then
he may come near to celebrate it, and he shall be like a native of the land. But
no uncircumcised man may eat of it. 49 "The same law shall apply to both the
native and the foreigner who resides among you." 50 Then all the Israelites did
this—they did just as the LORD had commanded Moses and Aaron. 51 And
on that very day the LORD brought the Israelites out of the land of Egypt by
their divisions.

13 Then the LORD said to Moses, 2 "Consecrate to Me every firstborn male.
The firstborn from every womb among the Israelites belongs to Me, both of man
and beast." 3 So Moses told the people, "Remember this day, the day you came
out of Egypt, out of the house of slavery; for the LORD brought you out of
it by the strength of His hand. And nothing leavened shall be eaten." 4 Today,
in the month of Abib, you are leaving. 5 And when the LORD brings you into
the land of the Canaanites, Hittites, Amorites, Hivites, and Jebusites—the land
He swore to your fathers that He would give you, a land flowing with milk and
honey—you shall keep this service in this month. 6 For seven days you are to eat
unleavened bread, and on the seventh day there shall be a feast to the LORD.

7 Unleavened bread shall be eaten during those seven days. Nothing leavened
may be found among you, nor shall leaven be found anywhere within
your borders. 8 And on that day you are to explain to your son, 'This is because
of what the LORD did for me when I came out of Egypt.' 9 It shall be a sign for
you on your hand and a reminder on your forehead that the Law of the LORD is
to be on your lips. For with a mighty hand the LORD brought you out of Egypt.

10 Therefore you shall keep this statute at the appointed time year after year.
11 And after the LORD brings you into the land of the Canaanites and gives it to
you, as He swore to you and your fathers, 12 you are to present to the LORD the
firstborn male of every womb. All the firstborn males of your livestock belong
to the LORD. 13 You must redeem every firstborn donkey with a lamb, and if
you do not redeem it, you are to break its neck. And every firstborn of your sons
you must redeem.

[14] In the future, when your son asks you, 'What does this mean?' you are to
tell him, 'With a mighty hand the LORD brought us out of Egypt, out of the
house of slavery.' [15] And when Pharaoh stubbornly refused to let us go, the
LORD killed every firstborn in the land of Egypt, both of man and beast. This
is why I sacrifice to the LORD the firstborn male of every womb, but I redeem
all the firstborn of my sons.' [16] "So it shall serve as a sign on your hand and a
symbol on your forehead, for with a mighty hand the LORD brought us out
of Egypt." [17] When Pharaoh let the people go, God did not lead them along the
road through the land of the Philistines, though it was shorter. For God said, "If
the people face war, they might change their minds and return to Egypt." [18] So
God led the people around by the way of the wilderness toward the Red Sea. And
the Israelites left the land of Egypt arrayed for battle. [19] Moses took the bones of
Joseph with him because Joseph had made the sons of Israel swear a solemn oath
when he said, "God will surely attend to you, and then you must carry my bones
with you from this place." [20] They set out from Succoth and camped at Etham
on the edge of the wilderness. [21] And the LORD went before them in a pillar of
cloud to guide their way by day, and in a pillar of fire to give them light by night,
so that they could travel by day or night. [22] Neither the pillar of cloud by day nor
the pillar of fire by night left its place before the people.

14 Then the LORD said to Moses, [2] "Tell the Israelites to turn back and
encamp before Pi-hahiroth, between Migdol and the sea. You are to encamp by
the sea, directly opposite Baal-zephon." [3] For Pharaoh will say of the Israelites,
'They are wandering the land in confusion; the wilderness has boxed them in.'
[4] "And I will harden Pharaoh's heart so that he will pursue them. But I will gain
honor by means of Pharaoh and all his army, and the Egyptians will know that I
am the LORD." So this is what the Israelites did. [5] When the king of Egypt was
told that the people had fled, Pharaoh and his officials changed their minds about
them and said, "What have we done? We have released Israel from serving us."
[6] So Pharaoh prepared his chariot and took his army with him. [7] He took 600 of
the best chariots, and all the other chariots of Egypt, with officers over all of them.
[8] And the LORD hardened the heart of Pharaoh king of Egypt so that he pursued
the Israelites, who were marching out defiantly. [9] The Egyptians—all Pharaoh's
horses and chariots, horsemen and troops—pursued the Israelites and overtook
them as they camped by the sea near Pi-hahiroth, opposite Baal-zephon.

[10] As Pharaoh approached, the Israelites looked up and saw the Egyptians
marching after them, and they were terrified and cried out to the LORD. [11] They
said to Moses, "Was it because there were no graves in Egypt that you brought
us into the wilderness to die? What have you done to us by bringing us out
of Egypt?" [12] "Did we not say to you in Egypt, 'Leave us alone so that we may
serve the Egyptians'? For it would have been better for us to serve the Egyptians
than to die in the wilderness." [13] But Moses told the people, "Do not be afraid.
Stand firm and you will see the LORD's salvation, which He will accomplish
for you today; for the Egyptians you see today, you will never see again." [14] "The
LORD will fight for you; you need only to be still."

[15] Then the LORD said to Moses, "Why are you crying out to Me? Tell the
Israelites to go forward." [16] And as for you, lift up your staff and stretch out your
hand over the sea and divide it, so that the Israelites can go through the sea on
dry ground. [17] And I will harden the hearts of the Egyptians so that they will go
in after them. Then I will gain honor by means of Pharaoh and all his army and
chariots and horsemen. [18] "The Egyptians will know that I am the LORD when I
am honored through Pharaoh, his chariots, and his horsemen." [19] And the angel
of God, who had gone before the camp of Israel, withdrew and went behind
them. The pillar of cloud also moved from before them and stood behind them,
[20] so that it came between the camps of Egypt and Israel. The cloud was there
in the darkness, but it lit up the night. So all night long neither camp went near
the other. [21] Then Moses stretched out his hand over the sea, and all that night
the LORD drove back the sea with a strong east wind that turned it into dry
land. So the waters were divided, [22] and the Israelites went through the sea on dry
ground, with walls of water on their right and on their left. [23] And the Egyptians
chased after them—all Pharaoh's horses, chariots, and horsemen—and followed
them into the sea. [24] At morning watch, however, the LORD looked down on
the army of the Egyptians from the pillar of fire and cloud, and He threw their
camp into confusion. [25] He caused their chariot wheels to wobble, so that they
had difficulty driving. "Let us flee from the Israelites," said the Egyptians, "for
the LORD is fighting for them against Egypt!" [26] Then the LORD said to Moses,
"Stretch out your hand over the sea, so that the waters may flow back over the
Egyptians and their chariots and horsemen." [27] So Moses stretched out his hand
over the sea, and at daybreak the sea returned to its normal state. As the Egyptians
were retreating, the LORD swept them into the sea. [28] The waters flowed back
and covered the chariots and horsemen—the entire army of Pharaoh that had
chased the Israelites into the sea. Not one of them survived. [29] But the Israelites
had walked through the sea on dry ground, with walls of water on their right and
on their left. [30] That day the LORD saved Israel from the hand of the Egyptians,
and Israel saw the Egyptians dead on the shore. [31] When Israel saw the great power
that the LORD had exercised over the Egyptians, the people feared the LORD
and believed in Him and in His servant Moses.

15 Then Moses and the Israelites sang this song to the LORD: "I will sing
to the LORD, for He is highly exalted. The horse and rider He has thrown
into the sea." [2] The LORD is my strength and my song, and He has become
my salvation. He is my God, and I will praise Him, my father's God, and I will
exalt Him. [3] The LORD is a warrior, the LORD is His name. [4] Pharaoh's chariots
and army He has cast into the sea; the finest of his officers are drowned in the
Red Sea. [5] The depths have covered them; they sank there like a stone. [6] Your right
hand, O LORD, is majestic in power; Your right hand, O LORD, has shattered
the enemy. [7] You overthrew Your adversaries by Your great majesty. You unleashed
Your burning wrath; it consumed them like stubble. [8] At the blast of Your nostrils
the waters piled up; like a wall the currents stood firm; the depths congealed in
the heart of the sea.

[9] The enemy declared, 'I will pursue, I will overtake. I will divide the spoils; I
will gorge myself on them. I will draw my sword; my hand will destroy them.'
[10] But You blew with Your breath, and the sea covered them. They sank like lead
in the mighty waters. [11] Who among the gods is like You, O LORD? Who is
like You—majestic in holiness, revered with praises, performing wonders? [12] You
stretched out Your right hand, and the earth swallowed them up. [13] With loving
devotion You will lead the people You have redeemed; with Your strength You
will guide them to Your holy dwelling. [14] The nations will hear and tremble;
anguish will grip the dwellers of Philistia.

[15] Then the chiefs of Edom will be dismayed; trembling will seize the leaders
of Moab; those who dwell in Canaan will melt away, [16] and terror and dread will
fall on them. By the power of Your arm they will be as still as a stone until Your
people pass by, O LORD, until the people You have bought pass by. [17] You will
bring them in and plant them on the mountain of Your inheritance— the place,
O LORD, You have prepared for Your dwelling, the sanctuary, O Lord, Your
hands have established.

[18] "The LORD will reign forever and ever!" [19] For when Pharaoh's horses,
chariots, and horsemen went into the sea, the LORD brought the waters of the
sea back over them. But the Israelites walked through the sea on dry ground.
[20] Then Miriam the prophetess, Aaron's sister, took a tambourine in her hand,
and all the women followed her with tambourines and dancing. [21] And Miriam
sang back to them: "Sing to the LORD, for He is highly exalted; the horse and
rider He has thrown into the sea." [22] Then Moses led Israel from the Red Sea, and
they went out into the Desert of Shur. For three days they walked in the desert
without finding water. [23] And when they came to Marah, they could not drink
the water there because it was bitter. (That is why it was named Marah.) [24] So the
people grumbled against Moses, saying, "What are we to drink?" [25] And Moses
cried out to the LORD, and the LORD showed him a log. And when he cast it
into the waters, they were sweetened. There the LORD made for them a statute
and an ordinance, and there He tested them, [26] saying, "If you will listen carefully
to the voice of the LORD your God, and do what is right in His eyes, and pay
attention to His commands, and keep all His statutes, then I will not bring on
you any of the diseases I inflicted on the Egyptians. For I am the LORD who
heals you." [27] Then they came to Elim, where there were twelve springs of water
and seventy palm trees, and they camped there by the waters.

16 On the fifteenth day of the second month after they had left the land
of Egypt, the whole congregation of Israel set out from Elim and came to the
Desert of Sin, which is between Elim and Sinai. [2] And there in the desert they all
grumbled against Moses and Aaron. [3] "If only we had died by the LORD's hand
in the land of Egypt!" they said. "There we sat by pots of meat and ate our fill
of bread, but you have brought us into this desert to starve this whole assembly
to death!" [4] Then the LORD said to Moses, "Behold, I will rain down bread
from heaven for you. Each day the people are to go out and gather enough for
that day. In this way I will test whether or not they will follow My instructions."
[5] "Then on the sixth day, when they prepare what they bring in, it will be twice
as much as they gather on the other days." [6] So Moses and Aaron said to all the
Israelites, "This evening you will know that it was the LORD who brought you
out of the land of Egypt," [7] "and in the morning you will see the LORD's glory,
because He has heard your grumbling against Him. For who are we that you
should grumble against us?" [8] And Moses added, "The LORD will give you meat
to eat this evening and bread to fill you in the morning, for He has heard your
grumbling against Him. Who are we? Your grumblings are not against us but
against the LORD." [9] Then Moses said to Aaron, "Tell the whole congregation
of Israel, 'Come before the LORD, for He has heard your grumbling.'" [10] And as
Aaron was speaking to the whole congregation of Israel, they looked toward the
desert, and there in a cloud the glory of the LORD appeared. [11] Then the LORD
said to Moses, [12] "I have heard the grumbling of the Israelites. Tell them, 'At
twilight you will eat meat, and in the morning you will be filled with bread. Then
you will know that I am the LORD your God.'" [13] That evening quail came and
covered the camp, and in the morning there was a layer of dew around the camp.
[14] When the layer of dew had evaporated, there were thin flakes on the desert
floor, as fine as frost on the ground. [15] When the Israelites saw it, they asked one
another, "What is it?" For they did not know what it was. So Moses told them, "It
is the bread that the LORD has given you to eat." [16] "This is what the LORD has
commanded: 'Each one is to gather as much as he needs. You may take an omer
for each person in your tent.'" [17] So the Israelites did this. Some gathered more,
and some less. [18] When they measured it by the omer, he who gathered much
had no excess, and he who gathered little had no shortfall. Each one gathered as
much as he needed to eat. [19] Then Moses said to them, "No one may keep any
of it until morning." [20] But they did not listen to Moses; some people left part
of it until morning, and it became infested with maggots and began to smell. So
Moses was angry with them. [21] Every morning each one gathered as much as was

needed, and when the sun grew hot, it melted away. 22 On the sixth day, they
gathered twice as much food—two omers per person—and all the leaders of the
congregation came and reported this to Moses. 23 He told them, "This is what
the LORD has said: 'Tomorrow is to be a day of complete rest, a holy Sabbath
to the LORD. So bake what you want to bake, and boil what you want to boil.
Then set aside whatever remains and keep it until morning.'"

24 So they set it aside until morning as Moses had commanded, and it did not
smell or contain any maggots.

25 "Eat it today," Moses said, "because today is a Sabbath to the LORD. Today
you will not find anything in the field." 26 "For six days you may gather, but on
the seventh day, the Sabbath, it will not be there." 27 Yet on the seventh day some
of the people went out to gather, but they did not find anything. 28 Then the
LORD said to Moses, "How long will you refuse to keep My commandments
and instructions?" 29 "Understand that the LORD has given you the Sabbath;
that is why on the sixth day He will give you bread for two days. On the seventh
day, everyone must stay where he is; no one may leave his place." 30 So the people
rested on the seventh day. 31 Now the house of Israel called the bread manna. It
was white like coriander seed and tasted like wafers made with honey. 32 Moses
said, "This is what the LORD has commanded: 'Keep an omer of manna for the
generations to come, so that they may see the bread I fed you in the wilderness
when I brought you out of the land of Egypt.'" 33 So Moses told Aaron, "Take
a jar and fill it with an omer of manna. Then place it before the LORD to be
preserved for the generations to come." 34 And Aaron placed it in front of the
Testimony, to be preserved just as the LORD had commanded Moses. 35 The
Israelites ate manna forty years, until they came to a land where they could settle;
they ate manna until they reached the border of Canaan. 36 (Now an omer is a
tenth of an ephah.)

17 Then the whole congregation of Israel left the Desert of Sin, moving from
place to place as the LORD commanded. They camped at Rephidim, but there
was no water for the people to drink. 2 So the people contended with Moses,
"Give us water to drink." "Why do you contend with me?" Moses replied. "Why
do you test the LORD?" 3 But the people thirsted for water there, and they
grumbled against Moses: "Why have you brought us out of Egypt—to make
us and our children and livestock die of thirst?" 4 Then Moses cried out to
the LORD, "What should I do with these people? A little more and they will
stone me!" 5 And the LORD said to Moses, "Walk on ahead of the people and
take some of the elders of Israel with you. Take along in your hand the staff with
which you struck the Nile, and go." 6 "Behold, I will stand there before you by
the rock at Horeb. And when you strike the rock, water will come out of it for the
people to drink." So Moses did this in the sight of the elders of Israel. 7 He named
the place Massah and Meribah because the Israelites quarreled, and because they
tested the LORD, saying, "Is the LORD among us or not?" 8 After this, the
Amalekites came and attacked the Israelites at Rephidim.

9 So Moses said to Joshua, "Choose some of our men and go out to fight
the Amalekites. Tomorrow I will stand on the hilltop with the staff of God in
my hand." 10 Joshua did as Moses had instructed him and fought against the
Amalekites, while Moses, Aaron, and Hur went up to the top of the hill. 11 As
long as Moses held up his hands, Israel prevailed; but when he lowered them,
Amalek prevailed. 12 When Moses' hands grew heavy, they took a stone and put it
under him, and he sat on it. Then Aaron and Hur held his hands up, one on each
side, so that his hands remained steady until the sun went down. 13 So Joshua
overwhelmed Amalek and his army with the sword. 14 Then the LORD said to
Moses, "Write this on a scroll as a reminder and recite it to Joshua, because I will
utterly blot out the memory of Amalek from under heaven." 15 And Moses built
an altar and named it The LORD Is My Banner. 16 "Indeed," he said, "a hand was
lifted up toward the throne of the LORD. The LORD will war against Amalek
from generation to generation."

18 Now Moses' father-in-law Jethro, the priest of Midian, heard about all
that God had done for Moses and His people Israel, and how the LORD had
brought Israel out of Egypt. 2 After Moses had sent back his wife Zipporah, his
father-in-law Jethro had received her, 3 along with her two sons. One son was
named Gershom, for Moses had said, "I have been a foreigner in a foreign land."
4 The other son was named Eliezer, for Moses had said, "The God of my father
was my helper and delivered me from the sword of Pharaoh." 5 Moses' father-in-
law Jethro, along with Moses' wife and sons, came to him in the desert, where
he was encamped at the mountain of God. 6 He sent word to Moses, "I, your
father-in-law Jethro, am coming to you with your wife and her two sons." 7 So
Moses went out to meet his father-in-law and bowed down and kissed him. They
greeted each other and went into the tent. 8 Then Moses recounted to his father-
in-law all that the LORD had done to Pharaoh and the Egyptians for Israel's
sake, all the hardships they had encountered along the way, and how the LORD
had delivered them.

9 And Jethro rejoiced over all the good things the LORD had done for
Israel, whom He had rescued from the hand of the Egyptians. 10 Jethro
declared, "Blessed be the LORD, who has delivered you from the hand of the
Egyptians and of Pharaoh, and who has delivered the people from the hand of
the Egyptians." 11 "Now I know that the LORD is greater than all other gods,
for He did this when they treated Israel with arrogance." 12 Then Moses' father-
in-law Jethro brought a burnt offering and sacrifices to God, and Aaron came
with all the elders of Israel to eat bread with Moses' father-in-law in the presence
of God. 13 The next day Moses took his seat to judge the people, and they stood
around him from morning until evening. 14 When his father-in-law saw all that
Moses was doing for the people, he asked, "What is this that you are doing for
the people? Why do you sit alone as judge, with all the people standing around
you from morning till evening?" 15 "Because the people come to me to inquire
of God," Moses replied. 16 "Whenever they have a dispute, it is brought to me
to judge between one man and another, and I make known to them the statutes
and laws of God."

17 But Moses' father-in-law said to him, "What you are doing is not good."

18 Surely you and these people with you will wear yourselves out, because the
task is too heavy for you. You cannot handle it alone. 19 Now listen to me; I
will give you some advice, and may God be with you. You must be the people's
representative before God and bring their causes to Him. 20 Teach them the
statutes and laws, and show them the way to live and the work they must do.
21 Furthermore, select capable men from among the people—God-fearing,
trustworthy men who are averse to dishonest gain. Appoint them over the people
as leaders of thousands, of hundreds, of fifties, and of tens. 22 Have these men
judge the people at all times. Then they can bring you any major issue, but all
minor cases they can judge on their own, so that your load may be lightened as
they share it with you. 23 "If you follow this advice and God so directs you, then
you will be able to endure, and all these people can go home in peace." 24 Moses
listened to his father-in-law and did everything he said. 25 So Moses chose capable
men from all Israel and made them heads over the people as leaders of thousands,
of hundreds, of fifties, and of tens. 26 And they judged the people at all times;
they would bring the difficult cases to Moses, but any minor issue they would
judge themselves. 27 Then Moses sent his father-in-law on his way, and Jethro
returned to his own land.

19 In the third month, on the same day of the month that the Israelites had
left the land of Egypt, they came to the Wilderness of Sinai. 2 After they had
set out from Rephidim, they entered the Wilderness of Sinai, and Israel camped
there in front of the mountain. 3 Then Moses went up to God, and the LORD
called to him from the mountain, "This is what you are to tell the house of
Jacob and explain to the sons of Israel:" 4 'You have seen for yourselves what I
did to Egypt, and how I carried you on eagles' wings and brought you to Myself.
5 Now if you will indeed obey My voice and keep My covenant, you will be My
treasured possession out of all the nations—for the whole earth is Mine. 6 "And
unto Me you shall be a kingdom of priests and a holy nation.' These are the words
that you are to speak to the Israelites." 7 So Moses went back and summoned
the elders of the people and set before them all these words that the LORD had
commanded him.

8 And all the people answered together, "We will do everything that the LORD
has spoken." So Moses brought their words back to the LORD. 9 The LORD
said to Moses, "Behold, I will come to you in a dense cloud, so that the people
will hear when I speak with you, and they will always put their trust in you." And
Moses relayed to the LORD what the people had said. 10 Then the LORD said
to Moses, "Go to the people and consecrate them today and tomorrow. They
must wash their clothes" 11 and be prepared by the third day, for on the third
day the LORD will come down on Mount Sinai in the sight of all the people.
12 And you are to set up a boundary for the people around the mountain and
tell them, 'Be careful not to go up on the mountain or touch its base. Whoever
touches the mountain shall surely be put to death.' 13 "No hand shall touch him,
but he shall surely be stoned or shot with arrows—whether man or beast, he
must not live.' Only when the ram's horn sounds a long blast may they approach
the mountain." 14 When Moses came down from the mountain to the people, he
consecrated them, and they washed their clothes.

15 "Be prepared for the third day," he said to the people. "Do not draw near
to a woman."

16 On the third day, when morning came, there was thunder and lightning. A
thick cloud was upon the mountain, and a very loud blast of the ram's horn
went out, so that all the people in the camp trembled. 17 Then Moses brought
the people out of the camp to meet with God, and they stood at the foot
of the mountain. 18 Mount Sinai was completely enveloped in smoke, because
the LORD had descended on it in fire. And the smoke rose like the smoke of
a furnace, and the whole mountain quaked violently. 19 And as the sound of
the ram's horn grew louder and louder, Moses spoke and God answered him
in the thunder. 20 The LORD descended to the top of Mount Sinai and called
Moses to the summit. So Moses went up, 21 and the LORD said to him, "Go
down and warn the people not to break through to see the LORD, lest many
of them perish." 22 "Even the priests who approach the LORD must consecrate
themselves, or the LORD will break out against them." 23 But Moses said to the
LORD, "The people cannot come up Mount Sinai, for You solemnly warned
us, 'Put a boundary around the mountain and set it apart as holy.'" 24 And the
LORD replied, "Go down and bring Aaron with you. But the priests and the
people must not break through to come up to the LORD, or He will break out
against them." 25 So Moses went down to the people and spoke to them.

20 And God spoke all these words: 2 "I am the LORD your God, who
brought you out of the land of Egypt, out of the house of slavery." 3 You shall have
no other gods before Me. 4 You shall not make for yourself an idol in the form of
anything in the heavens above, on the earth below, or in the waters beneath. 5 You

shall not bow down to them or worship them; for I, the LORD your God, am a jealous God, visiting the iniquity of the fathers on their children to the third and fourth generations of those who hate Me, [6] but showing loving devotion to a thousand generations of those who love Me and keep My commandments. [7] You shall not take the name of the LORD your God in vain, for the LORD will not leave anyone unpunished who takes His name in vain.

[8] Remember the Sabbath day by keeping it holy. [9] Six days you shall labor and do all your work, [10] but the seventh day is a Sabbath to the LORD your God, on which you must not do any work—neither you, nor your son or daughter, nor your manservant or maidservant or livestock, nor the foreigner within your gates. [11] For in six days the LORD made the heavens and the earth and the sea and all that is in them, but on the seventh day He rested. Therefore the LORD blessed the Sabbath day and set it apart as holy. [12] Honor your father and mother, so that your days may be long in the land that the LORD your God is giving you. [13] You shall not murder. [14] You shall not commit adultery. [15] You shall not steal. [16] You shall not bear false witness against your neighbor.

[17] "You shall not covet your neighbor's house. You shall not covet your neighbor's wife, or his manservant or maidservant, or his ox or donkey, or anything that belongs to your neighbor."

[18] When all the people witnessed the thunder and lightning, the sounding of the ram's horn, and the mountain enveloped in smoke, they trembled and stood at a distance. [19] "Speak to us yourself and we will listen," they said to Moses. "But do not let God speak to us, or we will die." [20] "Do not be afraid," Moses replied. "For God has come to test you, so that the fear of Him may be before you, to keep you from sinning." [21] And the people stood at a distance as Moses approached the thick darkness where God was. [22] Then the LORD said to Moses, "This is what you are to tell the Israelites: 'You have seen for yourselves that I have spoken to you from heaven.'" [23] You are not to make any gods alongside Me; you are not to make for yourselves gods of silver or gold. [24] You are to make for Me an altar of earth, and sacrifice on it your burnt offerings and peace offerings, your sheep and goats and cattle. In every place where I cause My name to be remembered, I will come to you and bless you. [25] Now if you make an altar of stones for Me, you must not build it with stones shaped by tools; for if you use a chisel on it, you will defile it. [26] And you must not go up to My altar on steps, lest your nakedness be exposed on it.'

21 "These are the ordinances that you are to set before them:" [2] If you buy a Hebrew servant, he is to serve you for six years. But in the seventh year, he shall go free without paying anything. [3] If he arrived alone, he is to leave alone; if he arrived with a wife, she is to leave with him. [4] If his master gives him a wife and she bears him sons or daughters, the woman and her children shall belong to her master, and only the man shall go free. [5] But if the servant declares, 'I love my master and my wife and children; I do not want to go free,' [6] then his master is to bring him before the judges. And he shall take him to the door or doorpost and pierce his ear with an awl. Then he shall serve his master for life. [7] And if a man sells his daughter as a servant, she is not to go free as the menservants do. [8] If she is displeasing in the eyes of her master who had designated her for himself, he must allow her to be redeemed. He has no right to sell her to foreigners, since he has broken faith with her. [9] And if he chooses her for his son, he must deal with her as with a daughter. [10] If he takes another wife, he must not reduce the food, clothing, or marital rights of his first wife. [11] If, however, he does not provide her with these three things, she is free to go without monetary payment.

[12] Whoever strikes and kills a man must surely be put to death. [13] If, however, he did not lie in wait, but God allowed it to happen, then I will appoint for you a place where he may flee. [14] But if a man schemes and acts willfully against his neighbor to kill him, you must take him away from My altar to be put to death. [15] Whoever strikes his father or mother must surely be put to death.

[16] Whoever kidnaps another man must be put to death, whether he sells him or the man is found in his possession. [17] Anyone who curses his father or mother must surely be put to death. [18] If men are quarreling and one strikes the other with a stone or a fist, and he does not die but is confined to bed, [19] then the one who struck him shall go unpunished, as long as the other can get up and walk around outside with his staff. Nevertheless, he must compensate the man for his lost work and see that he is completely healed. [20] If a man strikes his manservant or maidservant with a rod, and the servant dies by his hand, he shall surely be punished. [21] However, if the servant gets up after a day or two, the owner shall not be punished, since the servant is his property. [22] If men who are fighting strike a pregnant woman and her child is born prematurely, but there is no further injury, he shall surely be fined as the woman's husband demands and as the court allows. [23] But if a serious injury results, then you must require a life for a life—

[24] eye for eye, tooth for tooth, hand for hand, foot for foot, [25] burn for burn, wound for wound, and stripe for stripe. [26] If a man strikes and blinds the eye of his manservant or maidservant, he must let the servant go free as compensation for the eye. [27] And if he knocks out the tooth of his manservant or maidservant, he must let the servant go free as compensation for the tooth. [28] If an ox gores a man or woman to death, the ox must surely be stoned, and its meat must not be eaten. But the owner of the ox shall not be held responsible. [29] But if the ox has a habit of goring, and its owner has been warned yet does not restrain it, and it kills a man or woman, then the ox must be stoned and its owner must also be put to death. [30] If payment is demanded of him instead, he may redeem his life by paying the full amount demanded of him. [31] If the ox gores a son or a daughter, it shall be done to him according to the same rule. [32] If the ox gores a manservant or maidservant, the owner must pay thirty shekels of silver to the master of that servant, and the ox must be stoned. [33] If a man opens or digs a pit and fails to cover it, and an ox or a donkey falls into it, [34] the owner of the pit shall make restitution; he must pay its owner, and the dead animal will be his. [35] If a man's ox injures his neighbor's ox and it dies, they must sell the live one and divide the proceeds; they also must divide the dead animal. [36] But if it was known that the ox had a habit of goring, yet its owner failed to restrain it, he shall pay full compensation, ox for ox, and the dead animal will be his.

22 "If a man steals an ox or a sheep and slaughters or sells it, he must repay five oxen for an ox and four sheep for a sheep." [2] If a thief is caught breaking in and is beaten to death, no one shall be guilty of bloodshed. [3] But if it happens after sunrise, there is guilt for his bloodshed. A thief must make full restitution; if he has nothing, he himself shall be sold for his theft. [4] If what was stolen is actually found alive in his possession—whether ox or donkey or sheep—he must pay back double. [5] If a man grazes his livestock in a field or vineyard and allows them to stray so that they graze in someone else's field, he must make restitution from the best of his own field or vineyard. [6] If a fire breaks out and spreads to thornbushes so that it consumes stacked or standing grain, or the whole field, the one who started the fire must make full restitution. [7] If a man gives his neighbor money or goods for safekeeping and they are stolen from the neighbor's house, the thief, if caught, must pay back double. [8] If the thief is not found, the owner of the house must appear before the judges to determine whether he has taken his neighbor's property. [9] In all cases of illegal possession of an ox, a donkey, a sheep, a garment, or any lost item that someone claims, 'This is mine,' both parties shall bring their cases before the judges. The one whom the judges find guilty must pay back double to his neighbor.

[10] If a man gives a donkey, an ox, a sheep, or any other animal to be cared for by his neighbor, but it dies or is injured or stolen while no one is watching, [11] an oath before the LORD shall be made between the parties to determine whether or not the man has taken his neighbor's property. The owner must accept the oath and require no restitution. [12] But if the animal was actually stolen from the neighbor, he must make restitution to the owner. [13] If the animal was torn to pieces, he shall bring it as evidence; he need not make restitution for the torn carcass.

[14] If a man borrows an animal from his neighbor and it is injured or dies while its owner is not present, he must make full restitution. [15] If the owner was present, no restitution is required. If the animal was rented, the fee covers the loss. [16] If a man seduces a virgin who is not pledged in marriage and sleeps with her, he must pay the full dowry for her to be his wife. [17] If her father absolutely refuses to give her to him, the man still must pay an amount comparable to the bridal price of a virgin. [18] You must not allow a sorceress to live. [19] Whoever lies with an animal must surely be put to death.

[20] If anyone sacrifices to any god other than the LORD alone, he must be set apart for destruction. [21] You must not exploit or oppress a foreign resident, for you yourselves were foreigners in the land of Egypt. [22] You must not mistreat any widow or orphan. [23] If you do mistreat them, and they cry out to Me in distress, I will surely hear their cry. [24] My anger will be kindled, and I will kill you with the sword; then your wives will become widows and your children will be fatherless. [25] If you lend money to one of My people among you who is poor, you must not act as a creditor to him; you are not to charge him interest.